

Does where you live shape how long you live?

What London's deprivation data says about housing and health, and why it matters for affordable housing

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Introduction: a quick brief

Why	I'm a diagnostic radiography student who has always loved geography. I wanted to explore how place and housing connect to health.
Question	Do people in more deprived parts of London have worse health, and where does housing fit in?
Approach	I reviewed public data (the English Indices of Deprivation 2025 and ONS life expectancy figures), then evaluated what it can and can't show.

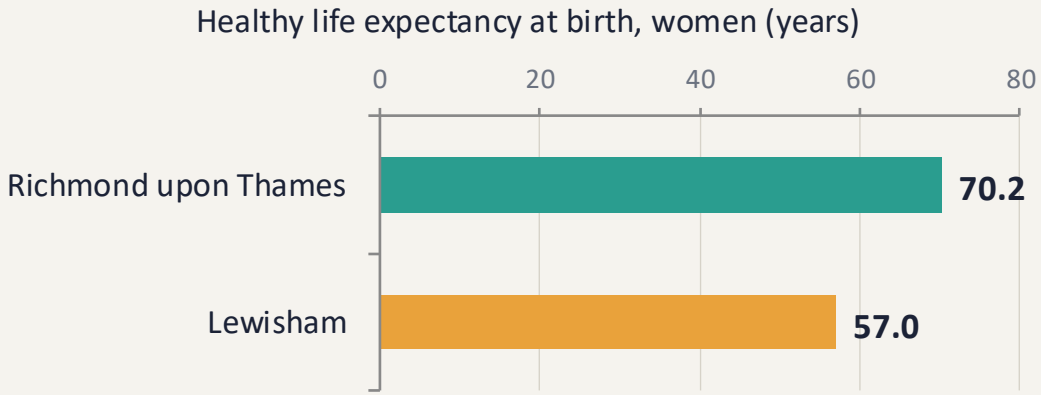
In this deck: how deprivation is measured → the health gap → what the data can't prove → takeaways and evaluation

Deprivation is measured across seven areas, and two are about housing

Income	Employment	Education	Health
Crime	Barriers to Housing & Services	Living Environment	**2 of 7** domains are housing-related

The English Indices of Deprivation 2025 combine these seven domains into one measure, the Index of Multiple Deprivation (IMD). Teal = housing-related (London Sport, n.d.; MHCLG, 2025).

Healthy life expectancy differs by 13 years across London



13.2

years of healthy life separate the highest and lowest borough

86 vs 81

Women's life expectancy (years): Kensington & Chelsea vs Barking & Dagenham

18.2 yrs

England-wide healthy life expectancy gap for women, most vs least deprived areas

Newham

Ranks as London's most deprived borough on average rank (IMD 2025)

Sources: ONS data via Trust for London (2025); London Health Commission (n.d.); OCSI (2026). Healthy life expectancy compares the highest and lowest boroughs for women, 2021 to 2023.

Correlation is clear, but housing is only part of the story

What the data shows

- Deprivation and health tend to move together across London
- Deprivation is uneven: between boroughs and even within them
- Low life expectancy is linked to poor diet, housing, education and employment

What it can't prove

- Health is one of the seven IMD inputs, so some overlap is built in
- Borough averages hide neighbourhood differences
- Correlation is not causation: housing can't be isolated from income and jobs

Housing is one lever among several, which is why affordable housing works alongside income, jobs and services.

Sources: London Sport (n.d.); Internet Geography (n.d.); London Health Commission (n.d.).

What this means for affordable housing

1

Place matters

I've always loved geography, and this project showed me how where people live shapes their health as well as their opportunities.

2

Data helps target need

Neighbourhood-level deprivation data can show where affordable homes are most needed.

3

Housing is a partnership

Affordable housing advisers work with housing associations, local authorities, investors and developers. I want to learn how that works in practice.

Sources: Trust for London (2025); MHCLG (2025); London Sport (n.d.); Internet Geography (n.d.); Savills (n.d.). Full references on the last slide.

Summary and evaluation

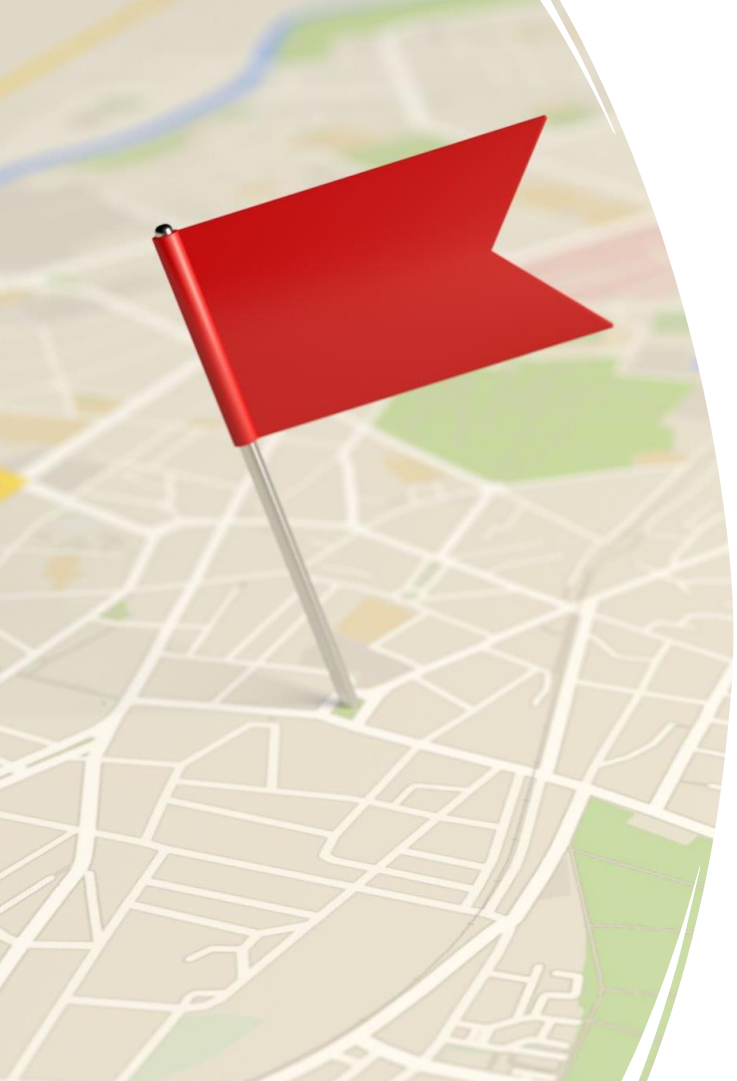
What I found

- Deprivation and health move together across London
- Healthy life expectancy for women varies by 13.2 years between boroughs
- Two of the seven deprivation domains are about housing

Limits and next steps

- I compared the two ends of the range, not all 33 boroughs
- Health is part of the index, and borough averages hide local differences
- Next: plot every borough against deprivation rank, using neighbourhood-level data

Bottom line: place-based data helps show where need is greatest. It is a starting point, not proof that housing alone drives health.



References

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